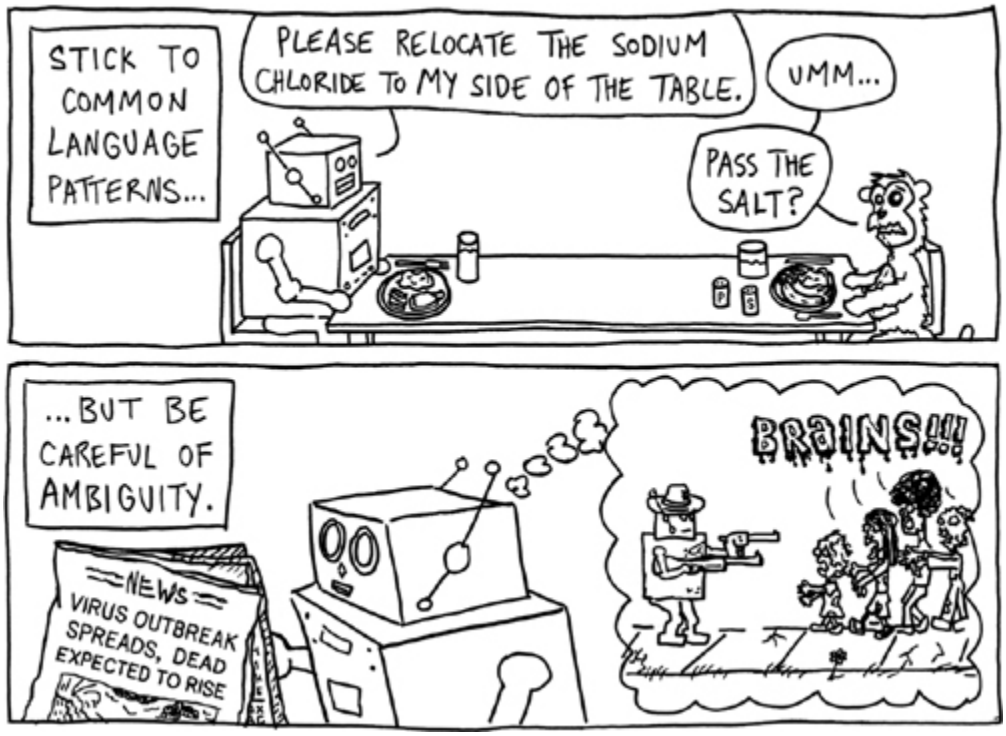


One final area for potential confusion is in the way CoffeeScript implicitly declares variables for you.

7.7.2. Implicit variables

Remember that variables are declared for you, implicitly, the first time a variable name is used. If a variable name is already defined *anywhere* in the current lexical scope (including outer functions), then that variable is used. This is unlike the `var` keyword in JavaScript, which will create a variable in the current function scope regardless of whether a variable with the same name exists somewhere in the current lexical scope (such as an outer function). If your programs consist of small modules (as discussed in chapter 12) and you don't have deeply nested lexical scopes, then this implicit variable declaration is unlikely to cause you any pain.

If implicit variables become a problem for you, or if you simply don't like implicit variable declarations, then you can easily get around the absence of shadowing by taking advantage of the fact that function parameters *always* shadow and create local variables with a `do` expression: